

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

Ps Barry's Reflections on: **PRAYER, PROCLAMATION and PERSONAL PROGRESS**

Bethel Global Missions

No.13. 22nd April 2024



SUBJECT: "WHAT SHALL WE THEN SAY TO THESE THINGS"? **Romans 8:31**

THE APOSTLE IS ASKING WHAT IS OUR RESPONSE TO WHAT GOD HAS SAID/DECLARED?

■ **WHAT SHALL WE THEN SAY TO THESE THINGS?**

Romans 8:31 What then shall we say to these things? If God is for us, who can be against us? NKJV – (should read SINCE God is for us - not IF he is)

JOB ASKS THE SAME QUESTION

■ **WHAT WILL I DO WHEN GOD CONFRONTS ME?**

Job 31:14 what will I do when God confronts me? What will I answer when called to account? NIV

► **JOB KNOWS** THAT HE WILL HAVE TO GIVE AN ANSWER TO GOD'S QUESTIONS

■ **GOD HAS DECLARED CERTAIN TRUTHS** THAT DEMAND A RESPONSE FROM US HIS CHILDREN, **TO STATE WHAT OUR POSITION IS IN RELATION TO CERTAIN TRUTHS DECLARED IN SCRIPTURE?**

► THIS STUDY IS ABOUT LOOKING AT SOME OF THOSE IMPORTANT AREAS OF OUR CHRISTIAN LIFE THAT WE NEED TO TAKE A POSITIVE POSITION OF BY AGREEING WITH WHAT GOD DECLARES TO BE TRUE.

OUR RESPONSE

■ **OUR POSITIVE RESPONSE CAN MAKE ALL THE DIFFERENCE TO OUR OUTLOOK ON DAILY LIVING AND FOLLOWING CHRIST.**

► IT CAN MEAN THE DIFFERENCE BETWEEN LIVING IN VICTORY OR DEFEAT.

► **FOR US** TO REMAIN UNDECIDED OR UNRESPONSIVE TO WHAT GOD SAYS, ESPECIALLY ABOUT THOSE THINGS THAT HE DECLARES TO BE TRUE ABOUT US AS ONE OF HIS CHILDREN **IS LIKE 'SITTING ON THE FENCE' AND DOES LITTLE FOR OUR SPIRITUAL STATE AND GROWTH.**

BREAKING THE BARRIER

► **WE MUST ALSO BREAK THE BARRIER BETWEEN WHAT OUR EMOTIONS AND THINKING TELLS US, AND WITH WHAT GOD HAS SAID ABOUT US.**

► **WHAT GOD HAS SAID, IS THE TRUTH AND KNOWING, BELIEVING, AND EMBRACING IT AS OURS** WILL MAKE THE DIFFERENCE BETWEEN LIVING IN LOW SELF ESTEEM AND POOR SELF IMAGE CONTRASTED WITH **LIVING WITH DIGNITY AND A SENSE OF WORTH AND VALUE.**

► **AGREEING WITH WHAT GOD SAYS IS TRUE BRINGS A NEW SENSE OF FREEDOM AND RELEASE AND CHANGES OUR WHOLE PERSPECTIVE ON EVENTS THAT WE ENCOUNTER IN LIFE'S JOURNEY.**

1. GOD HAS SAID HE WILL NEVER WILL I LEAVE OR FORSAKE YOU.

Hebrews 13:5-6

5 God has said, "Never will I leave you; never will I forsake you." 6 So we say with confidence, "The Lord is my helper; I will not be afraid. What can man do to me?" NIV

Hebrews 13:6 That is why we can say without any doubt or fear, "The Lord is my Helper, and I am not afraid of anything that mere man can do to me." TLB

Hebrews 13:6 So we take comfort and are encouraged and confidently and boldly say, The Lord is my Helper; I will not be seized with alarm [I will not fear or dread or be terrified]. What can man do to me? AMP

■ OUR RESPONSE TO WHAT GOD SAID TO US

- ▶ **SO, WE CAN BOLDLY SAY:** THAT THE LORD IS MY HELPER, - **SAYING IT WITHOUT DOUBT & FEAR, WITHOUT DREAD OR BEING TERRIFIED, NOT SEIZED WITH ALARM, NOT AFRAID OF ANYTHING MAN CAN DO.**
- ▶ **WE CAN RESPOND WITH CONFIDENCE & BOLDNESS BECAUSE** GOD SAID IT TO BE SO.

2. WHAT DO WE SAY - IS GOD UNJUST? –

*Romans 3:5 But if our unrighteousness brings out God's righteousness more clearly, what shall we say? **That God is unjust** in bringing his wrath on us? (I am using a human argument.) NIV*

*Romans 3:5 But if our unrighteousness demonstrates the righteousness of God, **what shall we say?** The God who inflicts wrath **is not unrighteous, is he?** (I am speaking in human terms.) NET*

■ WHAT DO WE BELIEVE. WHAT IS OUR POSITION ON THIS MATTER OF GOD BEING UNJUST?

- ▶ Now sometimes in a moment of despair or facing something that seems unjust to us, we might have in a moment of time thought that God was not fair but let's disregard those times and address **WHAT OUR RESPONSE IS** to the question, **OF GOD BEING UNJUST TO JUDGE SIN AND EVIL.**
- ▶ **IT SHOULD BE A RESOUNDING NO TO THAT ASSUMPTION.**

3. WHAT IS OUR RESPONSE TO THE BELIEF THAT SOME CHRISTIANS HAVE THAT IT IS ALRIGHT TO CONTINUE SINNING BECAUSE WE ARE NOW UNDER GRACE - "SHALL WE CONTINUE IN SIN SO GRACE MAY INCREASE?"

Romans 6:1 What shall we say, then? Shall we go on sinning so that grace may increase? NIV

- ▶ **IS IT RIGHT THAT FOR BELIEVERS WHO ARE NOW UNDER GRACE DO NOT HAVE NOT TO LIVE A GODLY LIFE?**

Romans 6:2 By no means! We died to sin; how can we live in it any longer? NIV

- ▶ **A GODLY LIFE IS ONE THAT REFLECTS A HATRED FOR SIN. (GOD HATES SIN).**
- ▶ **IT IS SPOKEN OF JESUS THAT HE LOVED RIGHTEOUSNESS HATED SIN.**

Hebrews 1:9 Thou hast loved righteousness, and hated iniquity; therefore God, even thy God, hath anointed thee with the oil of gladness above thy fellows. KJV

Hebrews 1:9 "You love justice and hate evil". NLT

4. WHAT IS OUR RESPONSE TO WHAT ABRAHAM OUR FOREFATHER LEARNED / DISCOVERED

- ▶ **Abraham discovered that a person is justified by faith alone - without the works of the law.**

Romans 4:1-5

*1 What then shall we say that Abraham, our forefather, discovered in this matter? 2 If, in fact, Abraham was justified by works, he had something to boast about — **but not before God.** 3 What does the Scripture say? "Abraham believed God, **and it was credited to him as righteousness.**"*

4 Now when a man works, his wages are not credited to him as a gift, but as an obligation. 5 However, to the man who does not work but trusts God who justifies the wicked, his faith is credited as righteousness. NIV

- ▶ **WHAT DO WE SAY, WHAT IS OUR POSITION ON THIS MATTER**

BEING JUSTIFIED (DECLARED RIGHTEOUS) BY FAITH ALONE WITHOUT THE WORKS OF THE LAW

- ▶ **WHAT SHALL WE SAY – TO A PERSON BEING JUSTIFIED BY FAITH WITHOUT EARNING IT BY OUR OWN EFFORTS?**
- ▶ **What is our response to those who believe that we must be circumcised or worship on the 7th day or keep the ceremonial law of Moses – Example:** The Galatians Christians
- ▶ **Why do people following this teaching especially after they have experienced God's free gift of salvation, forgiveness of sins and accepted by God into his family.**
- ▶ **WHY ADD TO WHAT IS ALREADY ACCOMPLISHED?**
- ▶ **WHERE DO WE STAND IN REGARD TO THIS MATTER?**

Amen – God bless – Ps Barry